

TERMS OF REFERENCE (TOR)

Oxfam is a global movement of people who are fighting inequality to end poverty and injustice. Across regions, from the local to the global, we work with people to bring change that lasts.

Oxfam in Bangladesh (OiBD) has been actively engaged in various humanitarian and development initiatives for more than 50 years, striving to improve the lives and livelihoods of vulnerable communities nationwide.

Title	: Consultancy for Climate Justice and ESG Review of MDB-Financed Mega Projects in Bangladesh
Covered Thematic Area	: Climate Justice, ESG (Environmental, Social and Governance), Responsible Finance, Multilateral Development Bank Accountability
Project/ Programme	: Fair Finance Bangladesh (FFB), CJNRR
Assignment Location	: Bangladesh (with desk-based national and international research)
Assignment Duration	: 01 August 2026 - 30 November 2026 (tentative)
Contract Authority	: Oxfam in Bangladesh

1. BACKGROUND AND CONTEXT

Bangladesh is one of the most climate-vulnerable countries in the world. It is also one of the largest recipients of multilateral development finance in Asia, having received USD 21.1 billion in climate-related financing between 2016 and 2022 alone (FFA, Oxfam and ADPC, 2026)¹. However, more than 90% of this funding has come in the form of loans rather than grants (FFA, Oxfam and ADPC, 2026)¹, increasing the debt burden of a country that has contributed least to the global climate crisis. Out of the total climate-related development finance, only 14% came for climate projects exclusively, which can be termed as climate finance; while the rest was mainly for development projects with climate as a minor or major component².

Multilateral Development Banks (MDBs) such as the World Bank Group, Asian Development Bank (ADB), Asian Infrastructure Investment Bank (AIIB), and others are major financiers of large-scale infrastructure and development projects in Bangladesh. MDB-financed investments in Bangladesh commonly operate in sectors closely linked to livelihoods, natural resources, and ecosystem sustainability. The scale and complexity of these investments create significant risks if environmental and social considerations are not systematically integrated throughout the project lifecycle. Such gaps can result in adverse impacts and unintended consequences, with disproportionate effects on women, Indigenous Peoples, coastal communities, and other marginalized groups.

Fair Finance Bangladesh (FFB) is a civil society coalition working to ensure that financial institutions operating in Bangladesh adopt and implement responsible finance policies aligned with ESG principles and climate justice standards. FFB is part of the Fair Finance Asia (FFA) network, managed by Oxfam Novib and implemented in collaboration with national civil society partners, using the Fair Finance Guide International (FFGI) methodology to assess and influence the sustainability practices of financial institutions (FFA, 2024)³.

As Bangladesh pursues ambitious development and climate resilience goals, the demand for financing from Multilateral Development Banks (MDBs) continues to grow, particularly for large-scale infrastructure, energy, transport, water, and climate investments. Given the country's high population density, limited land resources, ecological sensitivity, and acute vulnerability to climate change, these investments often intersect closely with communities, livelihoods, and natural ecosystems. Ensuring that such projects are designed and implemented in line with international environmental and social safeguard standards is therefore critical to maximizing development outcomes while avoiding or minimizing adverse environmental and social impacts.

2. OBJECTIVES OF THE ASSIGNMENT

The primary objective of this consultancy is to conduct a rigorous Climate Justice and ESG review of selected MDB-financed mega projects in Bangladesh and produce evidence-based findings to inform FFB's policy advocacy and influencing work.

Specifically, the consultant will:

- Assess the extent to which selected MDB-financed projects contribute to climate-resilient, inclusive, and sustainable development outcomes, while avoiding maladaptation and unintended environmental or social consequences.

¹ Fair Finance Asia, Oxfam, and Asia Disaster Preparedness Center (ADPC). (2026). *Barriers to Inclusive, Accessible, and Effective Climate Finance: Case Studies from Bangladesh and the Philippines*. Retrieved from <https://fairfinanceasia.org/blog/ffa-trosa-and-adpc-launch-new-report-calling-on-climate-funds-and-governments-to-remove-climate-finance-barriers-for-asian-communities/>

² IDFBD. (2025). *Climate Finance in Bangladesh: Annual Financing Overview* URL: https://idfbd.org/wp-content/uploads/2025/04/Bangladesh-CF-Landscape-Final_COP29.pdf

³ Fair Finance International. (2025). *Fair Finance Guide International Methodology 2025: A Methodology to Assess the Sustainability Policies of Financial Institutions* (8th ed.)

- Assess how project costs, benefits, risks, and opportunities are distributed among different stakeholder groups, particularly marginalized and climate-vulnerable communities.
- Identify and analyze MDB-financed mega projects in Bangladesh across sectors such as energy, infrastructure, and water, based on agreed selection criteria.
- Assess each project's compliance with MDB environmental and social safeguard policies, including the World Bank Environmental and Social Framework (ESF), ADB Safeguard Policy Statement, and other relevant frameworks.
- Apply a climate justice lens to evaluate how project design, implementation, and financing affect climate-vulnerable and marginalized communities, including women and Indigenous Peoples.
- Review accountability mechanisms, grievance redress systems, and community participation processes in the selected projects.
- Assess the effectiveness of project governance, including transparency, accountability, stakeholder participation, disclosure, and grievance redress mechanisms.
- Identify gaps between formal policy commitments & on-the-ground realities focusing on ESG standards.
- Develop actionable policy recommendations for MDBs, the Government of Bangladesh, and national financial regulators.

3. SCOPE OF WORK

The consultant will carry out the following tasks within the assignment period:

Phase 1: Inception and Project Selection (Weeks 1 to 2)

- Develop an inception report, including a finalized methodology, project selection criteria, list of selected mega projects, data collection tools, and a detailed work plan with timelines.
- Conduct an initial desk review of existing literature on MDB safeguard frameworks, ESG standards, and climate finance accountability in Bangladesh.

Phase 2: Data Collection and Field Work (Weeks 3 to 8)

- Conduct secondary data review of project documents, environmental and social impact assessments (ESIAs), board papers, monitoring reports, and public disclosures of selected projects.
- Conduct structured stakeholder surveys with project-affected households and community representatives, where feasible, to quantitatively assess perceptions of environmental, social, governance, and climate justice outcomes.
- Develop and apply a standardized indicator-based assessment framework using predefined qualitative and quantitative indicators to evaluate environmental, social, governance, and climate justice performance across all selected projects.
- Conduct key informant interviews (KIIs) with affected community members, civil society representatives, government officials, and MDB country office focal persons where accessible.
- Apply a standardized ESG scoring or assessment framework, to be agreed upon with Oxfam during the inception phase, to assess each project consistently.
- Document community voices, case studies, and evidence of social and environmental impacts, including gendered impacts and impacts on marginalized groups.

Phase 3: Analysis and Report Writing (Weeks 9 to 12)

- Synthesize findings across all selected projects.
- Develop the final review report with policy analysis, case studies, and targeted recommendations.
- Prepare a concise policy brief suitable for advocacy with regulators, MDBs, and policymakers.
- Present key findings to Oxfam and FFB team in a validation workshop or briefing session.

Phase 4: Report and Policy Brief Printing and Delivery (Weeks 12 to 13)

The consultant will be responsible for the design, printing, and physical delivery of the final publications. Before proceeding to print, the consultant will share the draft copies of both the policy brief and the final report with

Oxfam in Bangladesh for review and endorsement. **Printing will commence only after Oxfam's formal approval.**

The consultant will:

- Design and print 200 copies of the Policy Brief.
 - ✓ The consultant will design and print 200 copies of a 2-page policy brief in standard A4 size using full-color (CMYK - 4C) printing on uniform 150 GSM art paper (matte) with center-staple (saddle/stitch) binding and a resolution of 300 DPI, delivering the final outputs alongside its editable Adobe Illustrator (.AI) source files and press-quality PDFs and .AI file.
- Design and print 100 copies of the Final Report.
 - ✓ The consultant will design and print 100 copies of the final report (35 to 40 pages) in standard A4 size using a 150 GSM matte art paper cover (4c+4c full-color) and 100 GSM offset inner pages with a mix of color and black-and-white print, utilizing professional perfect (glue) binding with a resolution of 300 DPI, and delivering the final output in a press-quality PDF and .AI file.
- Deliver all printed copies to the Oxfam in Bangladesh office address.
- Share endorsed soft copies of both publications with Oxfam prior to printing.

4. DELIVERABLES FROM THE CONSULTANT

Deliverable/ Activity	Format	Length	Details	Timeline
Inception Report and Work Plan	PDF / Word	5 to 7 pages	Methodology, project selection criteria, data collection tools, and detailed work plan	End of Week 1
Data Collection and Fieldwork	Field notes and interview transcripts	As required	Documented KIs, community voices, and secondary data review	Weeks 2 to 8
Validation Presentation	PowerPoint	15 to 20 slides	Summary of findings presented to Oxfam and FFB coalition	End of Week 9
Draft Review Report	Word	35 to 40 pages	Full ESG and climate justice review with analysis, findings, and case studies	End of Week 10
Policy Brief	soft copies (PDF & .AI file)	2 pages	Concise, advocacy-ready brief for regulators and policymakers	End of Week 11
Final Report with Design	soft copies (PDF & .AI file)	35 to 40 pages	Revised report incorporating feedback from Oxfam and stakeholders	End of Week 12
Printed Policy Brief and Final Report	Hard copies	Policy Brief: standard brief format; Final Report: as per approved draft	200 printed copies of the Policy Brief and 100 printed copies of the Final Report, designed and delivered to Oxfam in Bangladesh office. Soft copies to be submitted for Oxfam endorsement prior to printing.	End of Week 13

5. BUDGET AND PAYMENT SCHEDULE

The total available budget for this assignment is: BDT 1,500,000 (all inclusive).

Payment Schedule:

- 20% upon signing of contract and submission and approval of the Inception Report.
- 30% upon submission and acceptance of the Draft Review Report and Policy Brief.
- 50% upon approval of the Final Review Report and completion of the validation presentation.

VAT and Tax will be deducted at source as per the Bangladesh Government rules (approximately 25%).

6. EXPERIENCE OR PROFILE REQUIREMENTS

The organization/ individual(s) should have the following competencies:

Essential

- Proven experience in conducting policy research, ESG assessments, environmental and social safeguard reviews, preferably in the context of development finance or MDB-financed projects.
- Prior experience of at least **10 years** in policy research, environmental and social due diligence, or responsible finance advocacy.
- Strong understanding of MDB safeguard frameworks, including the World Bank Environmental and Social Framework, ADB Safeguard Policy Statement, and relevant international standards such as the IFC Performance Standards.
- Sound knowledge of climate justice concepts, including the differentiated impacts of climate change and large-scale projects on vulnerable and marginalized groups.
- Experience in qualitative research, including conducting key informant interviews and synthesizing community-level evidence.
- Demonstrated ability to produce high-quality policy reports and advocacy-ready briefs.
- Academic or professional background in Economics, Environmental Science, Social Science, Law, Development Studies, Sustainable Finance or a related field. A master's degree or equivalent is preferred.

Desired

- Familiarity with the Fair Finance Guide International ([FFGI methodology](#)) or similar ESG assessment frameworks.
- Prior engagement with MDB accountability mechanisms such as the World Bank Inspection Panel or ADB Accountability Mechanism.
- Knowledge of Bangladesh's financial regulatory landscape and its interface with international development finance.
- Established network with civil society, academia, or regulatory bodies working on responsible finance in Bangladesh.
- Experience in integrating gender and social inclusion perspectives into policy research.

7. REPORTING AND SUPERVISION

The consultant or the internal lead of the assignment will report to and provide regular updates to the Fair Finance Bangladesh Programme Officer and relevant Programme Manager at Oxfam in Bangladesh.

8. COMPLIANCE

Ensure compliance with OiBD's internal regulations and the regulations of donor organizations. The consultant must adhere to Oxfam Non-staff code of conduct, Oxfam GB Feminist principle, Oxfam Child safeguard policy, Oxfam Anti-fraud and corruption policy, Oxfam PSEAH policy and Oxfam Sexual Diversity and Gender Identity Rights Policy.

9. APPLICATION PROCESS

The proposals must be sent in English, electronically and the submissions must reach Oxfam via email at Ban_Consultancy@oxfam.org.uk with the subject line **"CJ and ESG Review of MDB-Financed Projects in BD"** by **19 July 2026 – 11:59 PM**.

To be shortlisted for evaluation against award criteria, the following documents must be submitted with this application:

Technical Proposal
Technical proposal / approach paper to conduct the assignment and achieve objectives including methodology, proposed work plan and timelines
Financial Proposal
▪ Detailed Budget: Breakdown of all costs. ▪ Total Base Amount: The total cost before VAT (<i>Note: Do not mention the tax amount separately in the budget; it must be included in the cost.</i>) ▪ VAT: 15% VAT applied to the total base amount. ▪ Grand Total Amount: The sum of the base amount and VAT.

Along with the technical and financial proposals, the following documents need to be submitted:

For Individual/Group Consultant(s):

- **Curriculum Vitae(s) (CV) of the proposed consultant(s)**, proving relevant experience and/or qualifications. If multiple people are involved, an outline of roles/ responsibilities also needs to be included.
- **Two relevant references** (minimum) for previous comparable assignments.
- **Evidence of previous work:** At least two recent work completion certificates.
- **Proof of last two payments/ rates** (required after selection process).
- **Legal documents:** Copy of NID, TIN, BIN, Proof of Submission Receipt (PSR) of the Income Tax Return for the latest assessment year, Trade License, Work Permit, as applicable.

For Consultancy Firm:

- A firm profile of a maximum of 2 pages, highlighting completed related assignments with client names, contact persons, and contact numbers.
- **Curriculum Vitae(s) (CV) of the proposed consultant(s)**, proving relevant experience and/or qualifications. If multiple people are involved, an outline of roles/ responsibilities also needs to be included.
- **Two relevant references** (minimum) for previous comparable assignments.
- **Evidence of previous work:** At least two recent work completion certificates.
- **Proof of last two payments/ rates** (required after selection process).
- **Legal documents:** Copy of the Registration Certificate, TIN, BIN, Trade License, Proof of Submission Receipt (PSR) of the Income Tax Return for the latest assessment year and any other relevant documents.

10. EVALUATION AND AWARD CRITERIA:

Incomplete applications will not be assessed, only quotations that meet the award criteria will be assessed. The quotations will be assessed according to the following criteria and distribution of points:

Award Criteria		Max. Points
Technical Criteria		
Capability/ competence of bidder to perform the required work	Demonstrated experience in ESG reviews, safeguard assessments, or responsible finance research, preferably related to MDB-financed projects.	15
	Depth of understanding of climate justice, environmental and social safeguard frameworks, and accountability mechanisms of MDBs.	15
	Quality and relevance of previous similar assignments with evidence of high-quality policy reports or briefs produced.	10
	Project selection criteria, number of proposed projects to assess, relevance of the proposed projects for review in the methodology.	10
Quality of products/ services and ability to meet requirements	Clarity and rigor of the proposed methodology, work plan, and understanding of the assignment objectives.	10
Ethical and Sustainable Criteria		
Ethical/ Sustainable	Gender and Inclusion: Demonstrated approach to ensuring gender-sensitive and inclusive data collection and analysis.	05
	Safeguarding & Compliance: Commitment to Oxfam's Code of Conduct and relevant safeguarding policies.	05
TOTAL TECHNICAL SCORE:		70
Financial Criteria		
Financial offer	Cost Competitiveness	12
	Budget Breakdown & Transparency	07
	Value for Money	06
	Compliance with Requirements	05
TOTAL FINANCIAL SCORE:		30
GRAND TOTAL:		100

Oxfam withholds the right to conduct interviews/presentation with one or more potential consultants before an award decision is made. The purpose of the interview is to seek further clarification on the submitted quotations and learn more about the background and previous experiences of the potential consultants and their teams.

11. General Terms and Conditions

- All payment will be made through A/C payee cheque or bank transfer.
- The consultant shall be responsible for their statutory income tax obligations and/or insurance during the assignment.
- The payment will be made only after formal acceptance of deliverables by Oxfam in Bangladesh and OGB Global Team.
- Inability to comply with the works as per agreed timeline and quality will cause penalty from the payment. The penalty will be proportionate to the level of undelivered work.
- The consultant will ensure that data collection, processing and reporting meets Oxfam's high-quality standards and legal requirements (e.g., GDPR). The consultant shall have the responsibility to modify the report until the quality required by Oxfam has been reached.
- Confidentiality of information
 - The consultant will ensure appropriate ethical authorizations are in place, as required.
 - Informed consent processes must be followed prior to data collection including for interview recordings and photographs.
 - Interviewees will not be quoted in reports without their permission.
 - All documents and data collected will be treated as confidential and used solely for the purposes of carrying out this consultancy contract.
- All soft and hard copies of the assignment will be treated as the property of Oxfam.
- The consultant shall have no opportunity to alter the timeline and planning of data collection and submission of first draft and final report.
- In case of any deviation from the contract, Oxfam shall have the right to terminate the agreement at any point.

- The consultant shall be bound to pay back the full money to Oxfam given as advance of payment in case of any deviation from the contract.
- Oxfam will deduct withholding tax from the consultancy fees which will be in conformity with the prevailing government rates.
- Oxfam work is based on deeply held values and principles. The consultant will be bound by the principles and conditions of Oxfam Code of Conduct and other relevant policies, including those for safeguarding and child protection, throughout the duration of the assignment.
- Conditions for participating in the procurement process are detailed in the [Terms & Conditions of Bidding](#).

RIGHT TO SELECT/ REJECT

Oxfam reserves the right to select and negotiate with those firms it determines, in its sole discretion, to be qualified for competitive proposals and to terminate negotiations without incurring any liability. Oxfam also reserves the right to reject any or all proposals received without explanation.

RESERVED RIGHTS

All applications and quotes become the property of Oxfam, and Oxfam reserves the right in its sole discretion to:

- Disqualify any offer based on applicant's failure to follow solicitation instructions.
- Waive any deviations by the applicant from the requirements of this terms of reference that, in Oxfam's opinion, are considered immaterial defects requiring rejection or disqualification; or where such a waiver will promote increased competition.
- Extend the time for submission of responses after notification to all applicants.
- Terminate or modify the process at any time and re-issue the request for quotation to whomever Oxfam deems appropriate.
- Issue an award based on the initial evaluation of offers without discussion.
- Award only part of the activities in the solicitation or issue multiple awards based on solicitation activities.

CODE OF CONDUCT

Oxfam is committed to integrity in its operations and supply chains and ensuring high ethical standards. Complying with all laws and regulations and ensuring fair competition are fundamental to this commitment. We actively promote these principles and standards, and expect all Oxfam suppliers to demonstrate commitment towards them.

All consultants/applicant are required to agree and adhere to the [Oxfam Supplier Code of Conduct](#), whereas individuals (including consultants) must sign the [Oxfam Non Staff Code of Conduct](#)¹. These Codes of Conduct set out the specific standards and principles in the areas of human and labour rights, environmental impact and anti-corruption that suppliers must follow.

Oxfam has the following requirements of its service providers, to ensure integrity in its supply chain:

Bribery and Collusion

Oxfam does not tolerate fraud, including bribery or kickbacks, collusion among bidders, bribery or kickbacks. Any firm or individual violating these standards will be disqualified from this procurement and barred from future procurement opportunities.

Employees and representatives of Oxfam are strictly prohibited from asking for or accepting any money, fee, commission, credit, gift, gratuity, object of value or compensation from current or potential vendors or suppliers in exchange or as a reward for business.

False Statements

¹ Non-Staff Code of Conduct applies for any self-employed individuals or contracted employees of suppliers who are working on Oxfam sites, or who have access to Oxfam materials, or who may represent Oxfam in any manner but are not part of Oxfam's legal entity)

Bidders must provide full, accurate and complete information as required by this solicitation and Annexes. False statements in bids constitutes grounds for immediate termination of any agreement with the supplier. OXFAM takes misstatements, falsification, manipulation, alteration of facts and/or documents very seriously, has a zero-tolerance policy to such behaviours, and may choose to take legal action in a case of misrepresented disclosures by

Conflict of Interest

Bidders must provide disclosure of any past, present or future relationships with any parties associated with the issuance, review or management of this solicitation and anticipated award. Failure to provide full and open disclosure may result in Oxfam having to re-evaluate the selection of a potential bidder.

Diversion of Funds

Oxfam is determined that all its funds and resources should only be used to further its mission and shall not be subject to illicit use by any third party nor used or abused for any illicit purpose. Suppliers (and their affiliates/group companies, employees, officers, owners, agents and sub-contractors) may be subject to formal screening against global lists of individuals subject to designation or proscription under financial sanctions or counter terrorism regulations.

MONITORING

Due Diligence: As a charitable organisation, Oxfam must take care to protect its assets and funds. One of the steps that Oxfam takes to comply with this legal duty is to conduct adequate and proportionate due diligence on suppliers prior to entering into a contract. This includes checking legal registration and financial solvency but may also include other checks.

Important Note: Oxfam performs a regular screening check of all suppliers against international sanctions lists.

Audit: Any audit requirements are detailed in the terms and conditions of business.

Data Protection: Oxfam is legally bound to ensure that all personal details held by the organisation relating to any individual or entity are kept secure and according to international data protection standards.

MISCONDUCT REPORTING AND WHISTLEBLOWING

Oxfam's reporting and whistleblowing mechanisms are available for Suppliers as well Oxfam employees, to ensure that Oxfam continues to operate under the highest ethical standards and principles.

You can use these reporting channels confidentially, anonymously, and in your own language to report any concerns involving fraud, corruption, waste, abuse or safeguarding concerns.

Speak up – Oxfam GB		
Email:	SpeakUp@oxfam.org.uk	
Online:	Oxfam Misconduct Reporting Webform (including possibility for anonymous reporting) https://oxfam.clue-webforms.co.uk/webform/misconduct/	
Phone:	Global Phone Number: +44 1249 661808	

ANNEXES

Attachment 1: Code of Conducts

Oxfam Non-Staff Code of Conduct [English]

Oxfam Non-Staff Code of Conduct [Bangla]

Oxfam Supplier Code of Conduct

Conflict of interest declaration form for 3rd parties

Attachment 2:

OXFAM GB Feminist Principles

Attachment 3:

One Oxfam Child Safeguarding Policy

Attachment 4:

Oxfam Anti-Fraud and Corruption Policy

Money Laundering Prevention (Amendment) Act 2015

Circular of AML/CFT

Attachment 5:

One Oxfam Policy on Protection from Sexual Exploitation, Abuse and Harassment (PSEAH)

Attachment 6:

Sexual Diversity and Gender Identity Rights Policy